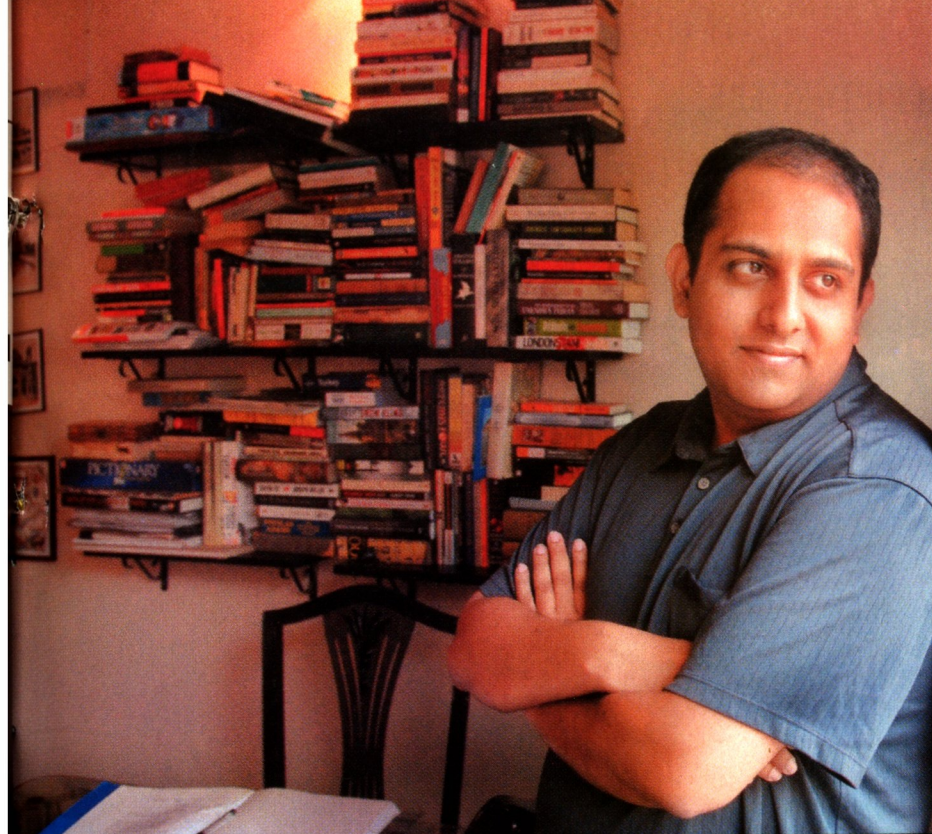




MANDAR DEODHAR

◀ ANUVAB PAL, 32

LOINS OF PUNJAB PRESENTS

"Hopefully there are enough people like me to create our own audience."



MANDAR DEODHAR



▶ CHETAN BHAGAT, 33

HELLO

"I came back after 11 years because when you're here you can replenish ideas much faster."



a Raymond Weil watch because of an infilm product placement deal.

Habib Faisal, news cameraman-turned-TV director-turned screenwriter for *Salaam Namaste*, *Jhoom Barabar Jhoom* and *Tara Rum Pum*, says the pressure to create something new is intense. "Earlier the formula was *hatke*, now it is *kitna hatke*," says the 41-year-old. Which is what attracts Gyan Prakash to Mumbai. The Princeton professor of history who

plans to take a year's sabbatical in July, got addicted to Mumbai while researching its history. The challenge of putting it on screen led him to write a short treatment, based on the city as it changed in the late '60s, for the god of all wannabe wordsmiths in Bollywood, Anurag Kashyap. A writer and director, Kashyap was with Ram Gopal Varma in his most fertile years and has a penchant for accumulating talented people. Sarkar, too, cut his teeth on

Kashyap's films, becoming one of 15 assistants on *Gulal*, which was never released, before moving on to that other collector of unusual talent, Sudhir Mishra, whom he assisted on *Chameli*, and collaborating with him on the screenplay of *Khoya Khoya Chand* and the forthcoming *Tera Kya Hoga Johnny*.

Film-writing doesn't always pay the rent, though. Most writers have well-paying day jobs or drone jobs in TV. Take Chetan Bhagat. After writing two